SSC CGL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

6 March 2020 · Shift 2

47 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 53 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20200710213341/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Final_Answer_key%20cgle19t1.pdf

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The SASTRA - Ramanujan Prize is awarded in the field of:

(A) Literature
(B) Dance
(C) Mathematics
(D) Chemistry

Q.2

The first electron shell which is the nearest to the nucleus never holds more than 'n' electrons, where 'n' is equal to:

(A) 8
(B) 2
(C) 6
(D) 4

Q.3

Which among the following is the food tube?

(A) Aorta
(B) Thymus
(C) Oesophagus
(D) Larynx

Q.4

The Battle of Chausa was fought between Humayun and _____.

(A) Nadir Shah
(B) Sher Shah Suri
(C) Hemu
(D) Krishnadeva Raya

Q.5

Which of the following is an east flowing river?

(A) Brahmani
(B) Sabarmati
(C) Sharavati
(D) Mahi

Q.6

In the context of rivers and their tributaries, which of the following pairs is correct?

(A) Alaknanda – Pindar
(B) Indus – Subansiri
(C) Godavari – Kabini
(D) Krishna – Manjra

Q.7

Which country hosted the 13th South Asian Games?

(A) Bhutan
(B) India
(C) Maldives
(D) Nepal

Q.8

Which of the following statements is correct with reference to the Karachi Session of the Congress (1931)?

(A) Mahatma Gandhi presided over the session
(B) The Khilafat movement was launched at this event
(C) The Gandhi-Irwin Pact was ratified
(D) The Quit-India Resolution was passed

Q.9
How many degrees does the Earth rotate about its own axis in one hour?

(A) 24
(B) 20
(C) 10
(D) 15

Q.10
With which sport is Archana Kamath associated?

(A) Lawn Tennis
(B) Badminton
(C) Table Tennis
(D) Squash

Q.11
Which female Indian cricketer won the BCCI C.K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award for 2019?

(A) Diana Edulji
(B) Anjum Chopra
(C) Jhulan Goswami
(D) Shantha Rangaswamy

Q.12
Which ISO certification pertains to Environmental Management Systems?

(A) 14001
(B) 27001
(C) 9001
(D) 22000

Q.13
Who is the author of the book 'Hazaar Chaurasi Ki Maa'?

(A) Krishna Sobti
(B) Mahasweta Devi
(C) Rita Kothari
(D) Sugathakumari

Q.14
Which of the following monuments is NOT a part of the Qutub Complex?

(A) Alai Darwaza
(B) Buland Darwaza
(C) Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque
(D) Qutub Minar

Q.15
Which of the following pairs is associated with the taxation system of the Marathas?

(A) Polaj and Parauti
(B) Iqta and Jagir
(C) Zat and Sawar
(D) Chauth and Sardeshmukhi

Q.16
In which year was NABARD established?

(A) 1979
(B) 1981
(C) 1982
(D) 1978

Q.17
Under which Article can the Parliament amend the Constitution?

(A) Article 74
(B) Article 269
(C) Article 368
(D) Article 374

Q.18
Which of the following states does NOT share its boundary with Bhutan?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Meghalaya
(D) West Bengal

Q.19
Under which of the following Amendments to the Constitution of India is defection to another party after election made illegal?

(A) 61st
(B) 52nd
(C) 92nd
(D) 86th

Q.20
Ozone at the higher level of the atmosphere is a product of _____ acting on oxygen molecules.

(A) gamma rays
(B) IR radiation
(C) x-rays
(D) UV radiation

Q.21
In July 2019, which among the following operations was launched by the BSF to fortify the Pakistan border in Punjab and Jammu?

(A) Garuda
(B) Vayuputra
(C) Chakravyuh
(D) Sudarshan

Q.22
Which of the following is a heritage site of Madhya Pradesh?

(A) Sasaram
(B) Hampi
(C) Lepakshi
(D) Bhimbetka

Q.23
In January 2020, with which country did India sign a MoU for content exchange programme between All India Radio and Betar?

(A) Nepal
(B) Bangladesh
(C) Sri Lanka
(D) Bhutan

Q.24
The Act that transferred the power from the British East India Company to the British Crown in India was:

(A) Government of India Act, 1835
(B) Government of India Act, 1858
(C) Government of India Act, 1833
(D) Government of India Act, 1947

Q.25
The Arid Forest Research Institute is located in _____.

(A) Dehradun
(B) Jaipur
(C) Ahmedabad
(D) Jodhpur

English Comprehension 22 questions

Q.1
Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. A child could understand his theory.

(A) His theory was understood by a child.
(B) His theory is being understood by a child.
(C) His theory could be understood by a child.
(D) His theory can be understood by a child.

Q.2
In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. We had a long discussion at a cup of coffee.

(A) a long discussion
(B) at a cup
(C) of coffee
(D) We had

Q.3
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pull a fast one

(A) Take quick action
(B) Progress fast
(C) Trick someone
(D) Believe someone easily

Q.4
Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. These lotteries organised by State Governments sell dreams. B. Lured by this, millions of poor people waste their hard-earned money. C. Crores of rupees and gold are offered as prizes. D. People buy lotteries hoping to become rich overnight.

(A) CABD
(B) DACB
(C) CBAD
(D) DBCA

Q.6

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. FICKLE

(A) Crafty
(B) Flighty
(C) Stable
(D) Subtle

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Agra's marble-marvel has such an overwhelming presence (1)_____ other monuments in the town have been relegated (2) _____ oblivion. Amongst such 60 odd monuments in (3) _____ town, the Red Taj is the most (4) _____ and relatively well-preserved. The tomb in red sandstone was (5) _____ by Ann Hessing, widow of a Dutch officer, after his death in 1803.

Select the correct option to fill in blank 2.

(A) on
(B) with
(C) by
(D) to

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Agra's marble-marvel has such an overwhelming presence (1)_____ other monuments in the town have been relegated (2) _____ oblivion. Amongst such 60 odd monuments in (3) _____ town, the Red Taj is the most (4) _____ and relatively well-preserved. The tomb in red sandstone was (5) _____ by Ann Hessing, widow of a Dutch officer, after his death in 1803.

Select the correct option to fill in blank 3.

(A) the
(B) a
(C) an
(D) their

Q.10

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Agra's marble-marvel has such an overwhelming presence (1)_____ other monuments in the town have been relegated (2) _____ oblivion. Amongst such 60 odd monuments in (3) _____ town, the Red Taj is the most (4) _____ and relatively well-preserved. The tomb in red sandstone was (5) _____ by Ann Hessing, widow of a Dutch officer, after his death in 1803.

Select the correct option to fill in blank 4.

(A) elegant
(B) active
(C) efficient
(D) adequate

Q.11

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Agra's marble-marvel has such an overwhelming presence (1)_____ other monuments in the town have been relegated (2) _____ oblivion. Amongst such 60 odd monuments in (3) _____ town, the Red Taj is the most (4) _____ and relatively well-preserved. The tomb in red sandstone was (5) _____ by Ann Hessing, widow of a Dutch officer, after his death in 1803.

Select the correct option to fill in blank 5.

(A) build
(B) to build
(C) building
(D) built

Q.12

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. HASTE

(A) Lose
(B) Rush
(C) Delay
(D) Dash

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. “If they will get married” , they will probably settle in Mumbai.

(A) No improvement
(B) If they will be getting married
(C) If they get married
(D) If they had got married

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Have you _____ for a job in this company?

(A) applied
(B) appointed
(C) approved
(D) supplied

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Rebel
(B) Edible
(C) Delegait
(D) Monarch

Q.16

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The both children go to the same school.

(A) same school
(B) to the
(C) The both
(D) children go

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. DISHEARTENED

(A) disgraced
(B) disliked
(C) depressed
(D) disgusted

Q.18

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. These are generated by a violent undersea disturbance or ocean activity. B. Once generated, they travel outward on the ocean surface in all directions. C. A tsunami is made up of a series of very long waves. D. Spreading thus, they look like ripples caused by throwing a rock in a pond.

(A) CABD
(B) BADC
(C) CBDA
(D) BDCA

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. CORDIAL

(A) hard
(B) rude
(C) warm
(D) cold

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. They “stopped to laugh” as soon as the teacher entered the classroom.

(A) No improvement
(B) stopped laughing
(C) stop laughing
(D) stopped laugh

Q.21

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. See eye to eye

(A) Stare at someone
(B) See clearly
(C) Agree with someone
(D) Be suspicious

Q.22

Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given group of words. Pertaining to an individual from birth

(A) Congenital
(B) Anomaly
(C) Habitual
(D) Chronic

Q.23

Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given group of words. To increase the speed

(A) Exhilarate
(B) Activate
(C) Accelerate
(D) Assimilate

Q.24

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Mahesh said to Rita, "Don't play in the sun."

(A) Mahesh told to Rita to not play in the sun.

(B) Mahesh ordered Rita that not play in the sun.

(C) Mahesh requested Rita that don't play in the sun.

(D) Mahesh advised Rita not to play in the sun.

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**		

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Mathematics

The SASTRA Ramanujan Prize, given by SASTRA University since 2005, honours mathematicians aged 32 or under (Ramanujan's age when he died) for work in fields influenced by him.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 2

A shell can hold at most 2 × (shell number)² electrons, so the first (K) shell, nearest the nucleus, holds at most $2 \times 1^2 = 2$.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Oesophagus

The oesophagus, or food pipe, carries swallowed food from the pharynx to the stomach. The aorta is the main artery, the thymus a gland and the larynx the voice box.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Sher Shah Suri

At Chausa, near Buxar in Bihar, Sher Khan (later Sher Shah Suri) defeated Humayun in 1539.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Brahmani

The Brahmani flows east through Odisha into the Bay of Bengal. The Sabarmati and the Mahi flow west into the Gulf of Khambhat, and the Sharavati west into the Arabian Sea in Karnataka.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Alaknanda – Pindar

The Pindar joins the Alaknanda at Karnaprayag. The Subansiri is a tributary of the Brahmaputra, the Kabini of the Kaveri and the Manjra of the Godavari.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Nepal

Nepal hosted the 13th South Asian Games in December 2019, in Kathmandu, Pokhara and Janakpur.

Q.8 · Answer (C) The Gandhi-Irwin Pact was ratified

The Karachi session of March 1931, presided over by Vallabhbhai Patel, endorsed the Gandhi-Irwin Pact and adopted the resolution on Fundamental Rights and Economic Policy. The Quit India Resolution came in 1942.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 15

The Earth turns through 360° in about 24 hours: 360° ÷ 24 = 15° an hour.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Table Tennis

Archana Kamath is an Indian table tennis player.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Anjum Chopra

SSC's key gives Anjum Chopra. At the BCCI awards on 12 January 2020 (for the 2018-19 season) she received the Board's Lifetime Achievement Award for women; the C. K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award itself went to Krishnamachari Srikkanth.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 14001

ISO 14001 sets out the requirements for an environmental management system. ISO 9001 covers quality management, ISO 27001 information security and ISO 22000 food safety.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Mahasweta Devi

'Hazaar Chaurasi Ki Maa' is the Hindi title of Mahasweta Devi's Bengali novel 'Hajar Churashir Maa', about a mother whose Naxalite son is killed.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Buland Darwaza

The Buland Darwaza, built by Akbar, is at Fatehpur Sikri. The Alai Darwaza, the Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque and the Qutub Minar stand in the Qutub complex in Delhi.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Chauth and Sardeshmukhi

The Marathas levied chauth (a quarter of the land revenue) and sardeshmukhi (a further tenth). Polaj and parauti were Mughal classes of land, iqta and jagir assignments of revenue, and zat and sawar mansabdari ranks.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 1982

NABARD, the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, was established on 12 July 1982.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Article 368

Article 368, in Part XX, gives Parliament the power to amend the Constitution and lays down the procedure.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Meghalaya
Sikkim, West Bengal, Assam and Arunachal Pradesh border Bhutan; Meghalaya does not.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 52nd
The 52nd Amendment (1985) added the Tenth Schedule, the anti-defection law, under which a legislator who defects is disqualified.

Q.20 · Answer (D) UV radiation
In the stratosphere ultraviolet radiation splits oxygen molecules (O_2) into atoms, which join other O_2 molecules to form ozone (O_3).

Q.21 · Answer (D) Sudarshan
The BSF launched Operation Sudarshan on 1 July 2019 to strengthen its anti-infiltration grid along the Pakistan border in Punjab and Jammu.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Bhimbetka
The Bhimbetka rock shelters, with their prehistoric paintings, are in Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh and a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Sasaram is in Bihar, Hampi in Karnataka and Lepakshi in Andhra Pradesh.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Bangladesh
Betar (Bangladesh Betar) is Bangladesh's state radio, the counterpart of All India Radio. The two signed their content-sharing agreement on 14 January 2020, at a meeting of the Indian and Bangladeshi information and broadcasting ministers.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Government of India Act, 1858
After the revolt of 1857 the Government of India Act, 1858 ended the East India Company's rule and placed India under the Crown, with a Secretary of State for India.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Jodhpur
The Arid Forest Research Institute, under the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education, is at Jodhpur in Rajasthan.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) His theory could be understood by a child.
'Could understand' becomes 'could be understood', keeping the modal: 'His theory could be understood by a child.'

Q.2 · Answer (B) at a cup
A talk held while drinking something is 'over a cup of coffee', not 'at a cup'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Trick someone
To 'pull a fast one' is to trick or deceive someone.

Q.4 · Answer (B) DACB
D introduces lotteries, A ('These lotteries') says they sell dreams, C names the prizes and B ('Lured by this') gives the result: DACB.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Stable
'Fickle' means changing often and unpredictably; its opposite is 'stable'. 'Flighty' is a synonym.

Q.8 · Answer (D) to
The phrase is 'relegated to oblivion': pushed aside and forgotten.

Q.9 · Answer (A) the
'The town' is the one already named, Agra, so it takes the definite article.

Q.10 · Answer (A) elegant
The Red Taj is 'the most elegant' of the monuments; 'active', 'efficient' and 'adequate' do not describe a tomb.

Q.11 · Answer (D) built
The passive 'was built by Ann Hessing' needs the past participle 'built'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Delay
'Haste' is hurry; its opposite is 'delay'. 'Rush' and 'dash' are near synonyms.

Q.13 · Answer (C) If they get married
In a first conditional the 'if' clause takes the present simple, not 'will': 'If they get married, they will probably settle in Mumbai.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) applied
One 'applies' for a job.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Delegait
The correct spelling is 'delegate'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) The both
'Both' comes before the article: 'Both the children' (or 'Both children'), not 'The both children'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) depressed
'Disheartened' means having lost hope or confidence: low in spirits, 'depressed'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) CABD
C introduces the tsunami, A says how 'these' waves are generated, B how, 'once generated', they travel, and D ('Spreading thus') what they look like: CABD.

Q.19 · Answer (C) warm
'Cordial' means friendly and sincere: 'warm'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) stopped laughing
'Stop' with the '-ing' form means to cease doing something; 'stopped to laugh' would mean they paused in order to laugh. They 'stopped laughing' when the teacher came in.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Agree with someone
To 'see eye to eye' with someone is to agree with them.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Congenital
'Congenital' describes a condition or trait present from birth.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Accelerate
To 'accelerate' is to increase speed; to 'exhilarate' is to make very happy.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Mahesh advised Rita not to play in the sun.
A negative command is reported with a suitable reporting verb and 'not to' + verb: 'Mahesh advised Rita not to play in the sun.'

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